the team room back at the hotel and I had to apologise, saying that I had been very unprofessional and that it wouldn't happen again.

I was fined R5 000, which made my escapade the previous evening the most expensive shag I ever had. Easily.

The 'Two Nights Before Club'

During the 2000 season, Mark Boucher and Jacques Kallis went through a purple patch. On the pitch. We're talking about cricket now. And they both attributed their successes to the fact that two nights before any innings in which they scored big runs, they had been out for a few toots. As a result they believed that they had unwittingly discovered the secret to a flood of runs, and it would be criminal not to include the exercise in their meticulous preparations before each game.

This little ritual was still going by the time of the 2001 tour to Australia, and, by now, had gained some dedicated support ers. One of whom was me. True to form, two nights before the first Test in Adelaide, we were out at a nightclub called Heaven, diligently preparing for our forthcoming innings.

Being the team man that he is, both on and off the field, Bouchie got together those in the squad who were keen on a little socialising and requested they wear their drinking caps, and we proceeded to have a few beers in Heaven. So to speak. I got really hammered, though, even by my high standards, and got back to the hotel at about … To be honest, I can't remember, but it was pretty damn late. Especially considering we had practice the next morning.

Anyway, the Adelaide Oval changing rooms were a little different from the way they are now. As you left the changing room and went down the steps along the passage and onto the field, the showers were on your left and the toilets on your right. I was sitting in the changing room waiting to play a little touch rugby as a warm-up before nets, and I was feeling really ill.

There were a couple of faces that were rather green around the gills that morning, but none of them compared to mine. I was *very* hung-over. I knew I was going to puke eventually, but I didn't want to use the toilets, knowing only too well that everyone would hear me, as the sound would've roared up and down that passage like one seriously annoyed tiger. I would have to park my cat in a somewhat more subtle fashion.